



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 9

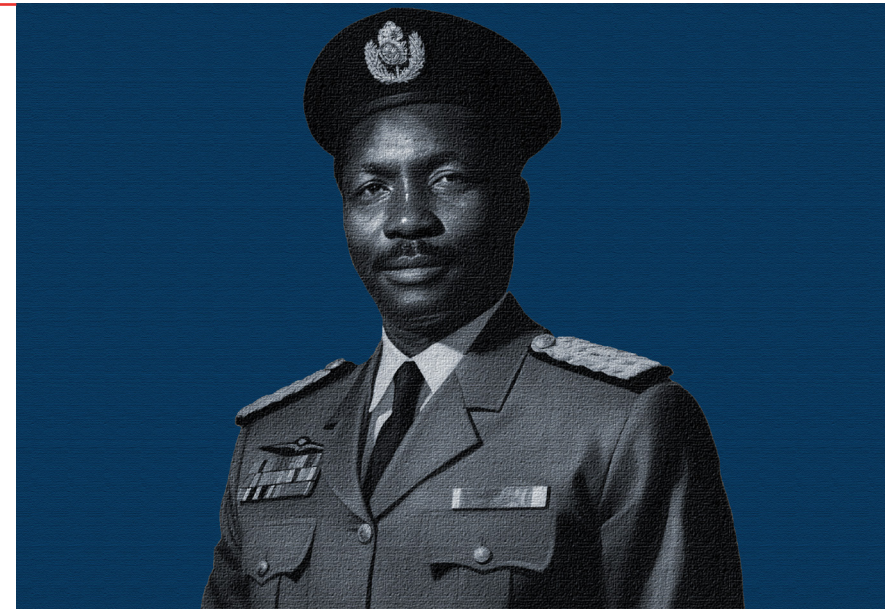
IN SUMMARY

This week, you learned about the 3 R's policy implemented by General Yakubu Gowon's administration in the aftermath of the Nigeria-Biafra civil war. This policy aimed to heal the nation's wounds and reintegrate the Igbo population through reconciliation, reconstruction, and rehabilitation.

Reconciliation sought to bridge the divides between ethnic groups, emphasising forgiveness and dialogue. Reconstruction focused on rebuilding war-torn infrastructure, while rehabilitation provided humanitarian aid and livelihood support to those affected by the conflict.

Despite these efforts, challenges such as currency exchange and property disputes hindered full reconciliation. You also examined reorientation strategies in Nigeria, including agencies like the National Orientation Agency (NOA) and programmes like Operation Feed the Nation, austerity measures, War Against Indiscipline (WAI), and Mass Mobilisation for Self-Reliance, Social Justice, and Economic Recovery (MAMSER).

The case study highlighted the historical context, objectives, and methods of these reorientation strategies. The lesson concluded by stressing the need to address underlying issues like corruption and poor leadership to achieve successful reorientation and foster values of trust, hard work, and moral conscience among Nigerians.



BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- The postwar policy of the Gowon regime in Nigeria, known as the 3 R's (reconciliation, reconstruction, and rehabilitation), aimed to address the devastating consequences of the Nigeria-Biafra civil war that occurred from 1967 to 1970.
- The policy's primary objective was to reintegrate the Igbos, the predominant group in Biafra, into the larger Nigerian federation after Biafra's formal surrender in January 1970.
- The 3 R's policy had three main components: reconciliation aimed to foster unity and understanding among different ethnic groups; reconstruction focused on rebuilding war-torn areas; and rehabilitation aimed to address the needs of war-affected individuals.
- The National Rehabilitation Commission was established to handle reconstruction and rehabilitation efforts, primarily focusing on the Eastern States.

CASE STUDY

Title: Reorientation Strategies in Nigeria: A Historical Analysis

Introduction: Reorientation strategies aim to reshape attitudes, beliefs, and behaviours towards specific goals. In Nigeria, various agencies and programmes have been involved in such efforts, including the National Orientation Agency (NOA), Operation Feed the Nation, austerity measures, War Against Indiscipline (WAI), and Mass Mobilisation for Self-reliance, Social Justice, and Economic Recovery (MAMSER).

Objective: This case study examines the key reorientation efforts in Nigeria and their effectiveness over time.

Methods: We analyse the history and impact of reorientation strategies in Nigeria, using a combination of historical data, policy documents, and public perceptions.

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

- Can you imagine the challenges faced by the government in reintegrating the Igbos into the larger Nigerian federation after the war?
- Why do you think the change in currency by Nigeria in January 1968 had such a significant impact on the Biafra region, and how did it affect the course of the war?
- How do you think the change in currency exchange terms by the government affected the perception of the 3 R's policy and the treatment of the Igbo people after the war?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

- Understanding the historical context of reorientation strategies in Nigeria
- Analysing the impact of government policies on social behaviour.
- Assessing the challenges and successes of reorientation programmes
- Developing critical thinking and policy evaluation skills
- Recognising the role of government in promoting national unity and development.

PERSONAL REFLECTION

Considering the historical context and the lessons from this class, what proactive measures do you believe are necessary to reconcile, rehabilitate, and reconstruct Nigeria today to promote national integration and healing?